Q+A

Don't Worry...

BE HAPPY. THAT'S THE DANCE-DRAMA FILM **ABHISHEK BACHCHAN** STARS IN, ABOUT A WIDOWER AND HIS DAUGHTER WHO HAS DANCE REALITY SHOW DREAMS



Photograph by
BANDEEP SINGH

Q. A film centred around dance.... Were you surprised director Remo D'Souza considered you for *Be Happy*?
Not at all. I love dancing. I did a film called *Naach* (2004). When Remo came—I have worked with him [as choreographer] several times and seen the films he's directed—I was excited to see what he'd offer me in terms of a story. Unfortunately, the role didn't demand that much dancing! I hope he'll give me the opportunity to dance for him in a dance film. Maybe if he did *ABCD* again? I'd audition for it.

Q. You received some of the best reviews of your career for Shoojit Sircar's *I Want to Talk*. Did your father give you a bouquet and a note as he does to those whose performances he's loved?
No. Maybe I should fight him more for it. My parents have always been constructive with their feedback. Even if they have not liked something, they have not been disparaging but guided me.... But I did get a very sweet message from my father.

Q. Both *I Want to Talk* and *Be Happy* are relationship dramedies touching on the complex father-daughter dynamic. You have a teenage daughter yourself. Were there moments where it felt like art imitating life?
My daughter thankfully has not hit that kind of teenage yet. Not just a father-daughter dynamic, but anything that is true to your personal life just makes that emotion accessible. A lot of your personality does bleed into the parts you play.

Q. It's your second collaboration with Amazon Prime. How was it this time around?
I started my OTT journey with Amazon Prime [*Breathe: Into the Shadows*]. It's nice that a platform decides to back a film which is telling the family to watch a film together and not individually. I hope it paves the way for more feelgood and family-oriented OTT content.

—with Suhani Singh